

Charlie Kley

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EDUCATION

Duke University

Durham, NC

Bachelor of Engineering in Mechanical Engineering, Mathematics minor

Degree Expected May 2027

Cumulative GPA: 3.96; Dean's List with Distinction 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026

Tools and Technologies: SolidWorks, Fusion360, Python, Arduino, Java, FEA, 3D Printing, Microsoft Suite, VBA

Relevant Courses Taken: Aircraft Propulsion, Heat & Mass Transfer, Fluid Dynamics, Control & Systems Engineering, Thermodynamics, Mechanics of Materials, Statics, Dynamics, Mechatronics, Structures and Properties of Solids

WORK EXPERIENCE

X-Bow Systems — Luling, TX

Summer 2026

Manufacturing Engineering Intern

- Designed and implemented a Manufacturing Execution System (MES) to track production and building occupancy, including an integrated andon light system for real-time production visibility
- Automated manufacturing-order material requests using Python and Excel VBA, reducing processing time from ~8 minutes to ~30 seconds per order while improving traceability and accuracy
- Developed and implemented scalable manufacturing improvements projected to save ~368 labor hours annually (46 working days) while reducing production stoppages, rework, and human error

Ford Audio-Video — Austin, TX

Summer 2025

Project Engineer Intern

- Supported installation and integration of large-scale AV systems for multi-million-dollar facilities
- Assisted in system commissioning and troubleshooting of professional AV hardware across high-profile projects, including the University of Texas Football Stadium locker room and venues with 800+ speakers
- Collaborated with engineers and contractors to ensure seamless deployment of audio-visual solutions

Neckog Industries — Austin, TX

Summer 2024

Mechanical Engineering Intern

- Responsible for designing and prototyping 10+ components of a desktop injection molding device
- Developed gear pumps, valves, sheet metal housing, and stepper motor assemblies in Fusion360
- Ensured strict tolerances for crucial parts like motor shafts and pump gears for high quality function and assembly
- Filed a provisional patent for a three-inlet manifold-gear pump including technical drawings
- Researched and obtained materials from local manufacturers for late-stage prototyping and testing of device

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Wildfire Burn Severity Predictor Using Geospatial Machine Learning

Spring 2025

- Applied machine learning (Random Forest classifier in Python) to predict wildfire burn severity with 70% accuracy using only Landsat 8 imagery and SRTM elevation data.

Children's Toy Space Maze Project

Spring 2024

- Designed an engaging space-themed toy in SolidWorks that is suitable and safe for a happy meal toy
- Designed pieces for injection molding, and calculated manufacturing costs to fit within budget constraints

Seeing Sounds Engineering Design Project

Fall 2023

- Collaborated to design and create an engaging way to visualize sound using multiple different inputs for the children at the Shakori Hills Music Festival using the engineering design process
- Presented our design to the client and at a showcase, and received positive feedback from the product's use

EXTRACURRICULAR EXPERIENCE

Duke Aerospace Engineering Club

2024 – present

- Machined precision rocket motor components ensuring compatibility and tolerance with 6 other sub-teams
- Manufactured solid propellant for a successful static hot fire and a 30,000 ft launch, including mixing, casting, and integrating propellant grains for motor assembly

Duke Adaptive Explorers

2024 – present

- Organized activities for individuals with disabilities, including hiking, kayaking, and outdoor sports

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Campus Activities: Pi Tau Sigma Honor Society, Duke SHAPE, Secretary of Theta Chi Fraternity, Duke Club Running

Languages: English (native), Spanish (conversational)